

This **Symbolic Code (Barthes)** was clearly successful as Procter and Gamble's competitor products were rapidly overtaken, making *Tide* the brand leader by the mid-1950s.

A level only:

Structuralism – Claude Lévi-Strauss

- The latter point above links to **Lévi-Strauss' theory**, whereby texts are constructed through the use of **binary oppositions**, and meaning is made by audiences understanding these conflicts.
- In this text, “*Tide* gets clothes cleaner than any other washday product you can buy!” and “There's nothing like Procter and Gamble's *Tide*”, reinforces the **conceptual binary opposition** between *Tide* and its commercial rivals.
- It's also “unlike soap,” gets laundry “whiter... than any soap or washing product known” and is “truly safe” – all of which **connotes** that other, inferior products do not offer what *Tide* does.

PART 2: STARTING POINTS – Representation

Social and political contexts:

Interesting **intertexts** to consider would be WWII adverts for the ‘Women's Land Army’ and J. Howard Miller's ‘Rosie The Riveter – We Can Do It!’ advert for the War Production Co-Ordinating Committee.

The **representations** in these adverts challenge **stereotypical** views of women being confined to the domestic sphere, something society needed at the time as traditional ‘male roles’ were vacated as men left to fight.

In the 1950s, while men were being targeted for the post-war boom in America's car industry, women were the primary market for the technologies and products being developed for the home. In **advertising** for these types of texts, **stereotypical representations** of domestic perfection, caring for the family and servitude to the ‘man of the house’ became linked to a more modern need for speed, convenience and a better standard of living than the women experienced in the pre-war era.

Consider how representations are constructed through processes of selection and combination:

- The **dress code** of the advert's main female character include a **stereotypical** 1950s hairstyle incorporating waves, curls and rolls made fashionable by contemporary film stars such as Veronica Lake, Betty Grable and Rita Hayworth. The fashion for women having shorter hair had a practical catalyst as long hair was hazardous for women working with machinery on farms or in factories during the war.
- The headband or scarf worn by the woman also links to the practicalities of **dress code** for



<http://www.womenslandarmy.co.uk/ww2-womens-land-army-newspaper-recruitment-campaign/>

http://americanhistory.si.edu/collections/search/object/nmah_538122

women developed during this time. For this advert, having her hair held back **connotes** she's focused on her work, though this is perhaps **binary opposed** to the full make-up that she's wearing.